SORT: -LE, -EL, -IL, -AL

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Every word in the bank ends in the same lazy "uhl" sound, but four different spellings make it. Say each word, look at the last two or three letters, and write the word in the matching column. Five words go in each column.

TWENTY WORDS

evil **little** **level** **animal** **purple** **nostril** **sandal**
apple **towel** **metal** **stencil** **table** **signal** **camel** **candle** **tonsil**
travel **pedal** **shovel** **lentil**

-le no vowel letter at all	-el spelled with e	-il spelled with i	-al spelled with a

The surprise in -le words. In **little** and **table** there is no vowel letter spelling the schwa at all. You say "lit-uhl", but the letters are l and e with the e silent and the l doing the whole syllable. That is why children who spell by sound write "littel" and "tabel". The -le spelling is by far the most common, so it is the one to guess first.

Sorting by ear will not work on this page, and that is the point. Travel, metal, pencil and little all end in exactly the same sound. These endings are learned by looking at words and writing them, not by listening harder.

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SORT: -LE, -EL, -IL, -AL ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... Date: .....

Every word in the bank ends in the same lazy "uhl" sound, but four different spellings make it. Say each word, look at the last two or three letters, and write the word in the matching column. Five words go in each column.

TWENTY WORDS

evil · little · level · animal · purple · nostril · sandal · apple · towel · metal · stencil · table · signal · camel · candle · tonsil · travel · pedal · shovel · lentil

-le no vowel letter at all	-el spelled with e	-il spelled with i	-al spelled with a
little	travel	nostril	metal
table	towel	stencil	animal
apple	level	tonsil	pedal
candle	camel	evil	sandal
purple	shovel	lentil	signal

The surprise in -le words. In **little** and **table** there is no vowel letter spelling the schwa at all. You say "lit-uhl", but the letters are l and e with the e silent and the l doing the whole syllable. That is why children who spell by sound write "littel" and "tabel". The -le spelling is by far the most common, so it is the one to guess first.

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